

TESSA MASIS

 [they/them/theirs](https://github.com/they/them/theirs)

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EDUCATION

- 2020 – 2026 ▶ **University of Massachusetts Amherst**
Ph.D. in Computer Science, expected September 2026
M.S. in Computer Science, September 2025
- 2018 – 2020 ▶ **University of Massachusetts Amherst**
B.A. in Computational Linguistics, magna cum laude
- 2015 – 2017 ▶ **Cornell University**
Prospective B.S. in Computer Science Engineering and Linguistics

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2020 – ▶ **Graduate Research Assistant**, University of Massachusetts Amherst.
Natural language processing and computational social science research
Advisor: Brendan O'Connor
- 2019 – 2020 ▶ **Undergraduate Research Assistant**, University of Massachusetts Amherst.
Linguistic probe task assessing deictic knowledge of pretrained language models
Mentors: Carolyn Anderson, Gaja Jarosz
- Summer 2019 ▶ **Analytics and Machine Intelligence Intern**, Raytheon BBN Technologies, Cambridge.
Trained models predicting word error rate from multilingual raw audio and ASR output

HONORS & AWARDS

- 2026 ▶ Conference Travel Award for NSF Fellows from the UMass Amherst Graduate School.
- 2024 ▶ PIT-NE Computing & Data Science Rising Star at Boston University.
▶ Passed Ph.D. Qualifying Exam (Portfolio) with Distinction.
▶ Community, Democracy, and Dialogue Grant from the UMass Amherst Office of Equity and Inclusion (with Jane Yeahin Pyo, Nora Suren, and Larri Miller).
- 2023 ▶ NSF Graduate Research Fellowship.
▶ Ford Foundation Predoctoral Fellowship Honorable Mention.
▶ CRA-Inclusion, Diversity, Equity, Accessibility, and Leadership Skills (IDEALS) Grad Cohort Workshop Participant (fully funded travel & arrangements).
- 2022 ▶ Anuradha and Hanuma Kodavalla Graduate Scholarship in Computer Science.
- 2020 ▶ Scholarship of Undergraduate Literary Studies Conference Travel Award.
- 2019 ▶ Out For Undergrad Tech Conference Participant (fully funded travel & arrangements).
- 2018 ▶ Alexander Rebelo DeSerpa Prize for Excellence in Beginning Greek.
▶ Out in STEM Annual Conference Travel Award.

PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- 1 **Tessa Masis**, Chloe Eggleston, Lisa Green, Taylor Jones, Meghan Armstrong, and Brendan O'Connor. "Variation across regions and demographics in African American Language morphosyntax: Evidence from large-scale Twitter data". In: *American Speech* 101.2 (2026), pp. 144–178.  [URL: https://doi.org/10.1215/00031283-12519827](https://doi.org/10.1215/00031283-12519827).

- 2 **Tessa Masis** and Brendan O'Connor. "Coordinates from Context: Using LLMs to Ground Complex Location References". In: *Proceedings of the 19th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL)*. 2026.  URL: <https://aclanthology.org/2026.eacl-long.74/>.
- 3 **Tessa Masis**, Zhangqi Duan, Weiai Xu, Jane Yeahin Pyo, Ethan Zuckerman, and Brendan O'Connor. "Multilingualism, Transnationality, and K-pop in the Online #StopAsianHate Movement". In: *Proceedings of the 17th ACM Web Science Conference*. 2025.  URL: <https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3717867.3717869>.
- 4 **Tessa Masis** and Brendan O'Connor. "Where on Earth Do Users Say They Are?: Geo-Entity Linking for Noisy Multilingual User Input". In: *Proceedings of the Sixth Workshop on Natural Language Processing and Computational Social Science at NAACL*. 2024.  URL: <https://aclanthology.org/2024.nlpccs-1.7>.
- 5 **Tessa Masis**, Chloe Eggleston, Lisa Green, Taylor Jones, Meghan Armstrong, and Brendan O'Connor. "Investigating Morphosyntactic Variation in African American English on Twitter". In: *Proceedings of the Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL)*. 2023.  URL: <https://openpublishing.library.umass.edu/scil/article/id/967/>.
- 6 **Tessa Masis**, Anissa Neal, Lisa Green, and Brendan O'Connor. "Corpus-Guided Contrast Sets for Morphosyntactic Feature Detection in Low-Resource English Varieties". In: *Proceedings of the First Workshop on NLP Applications to Field Linguistics at COLING*. 2022.  URL: <https://aclanthology.org/2022.fieldmatters-1.2>.
- 7 **Tessa Masis** and Carolyn Jane Anderson. "ProSPer: Probing Human and Neural Network Language Model Understanding of Spatial Perspective". In: *Proceedings of the Fourth BlackboxNLP Workshop on Analyzing and Interpreting Neural Networks for NLP at EMNLP*. 2021.  URL: <https://aclanthology.org/2021.blackboxnlp-1.8>.

Conference Presentations

- 1 Jane Yeahin Pyo and **Tessa Masis**. "Global Racial Solidarity? (K-)Popularization, Changes, and Erasure in Transnational Movements of #StopAsianHate". In: *Association of Internet Researchers (AoIR)*. 2025.
- 2 **Tessa Masis** and Brendan O'Connor. "Where on Earth Do Users Say They Are?: Geo-Entity Linking for Noisy User Input". In: *International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2)*. 2024.
- 3 **Tessa Masis**. "Exploring morphosyntactic variation in low-resource English varieties". Lightning talk presentation at CRA-IDEALS Grad Cohort Workshop. 2023.
- 4 **Tessa Masis**, Zhangqi Duan, Weiai Xu, Jonathan Corpus Ong, Ethan Zuckerman, Jane Yeahin Pyo, and Brendan O'Connor. "The Online #StopAsianHate Movement: More Global and BTS-Driven Than You'd Think". In: *New Directions in Analyzing Text as Data (TADA)*. 2023.
- 5 **Tessa Masis**, Chloe Eggleston, Lisa Green, Taylor Jones, Meghan Armstrong, and Brendan O'Connor. "Investigating grammatical variation in African American English on Twitter". In: *International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2)*. 2023.
- 6 **Tessa Masis**, Chloe Eggleston, Anissa Neal, Lisa Green, and Brendan O'Connor. "A large-scale Twitter-based exploration of morphosyntactic geographic variation in African American English". In: *New Ways of Analyzing Variation (NWAV)* 50. 2022.
- 7 Carolyn Jane Anderson and **Tessa Masis**. "Can neural network language models learn spatial perspective from text alone?" In: *Bridging AI and Cognitive Science Workshop (BAICS) at ICLR*. 2020.
- 8 **Tessa Masis**. "The Poetics of Gender Devaluation in Homeric Heroism". In: *Scholarship for Undergraduate Literary Studies Conference*. 2020.

INVITED TALKS

- 2024 ▷ "Adventures in computational social science". CICS 291S: Second Year Pathways, University of Massachusetts Amherst.
- 2023 ▷ "Investigating grammatical variation in African American English on Twitter". Bridging methods to study sociolectal variation workshop, LSA institute.
- ▷ _____. Learning & Work Equity Seminar, Institute of Diversity Sciences, University of Massachusetts Amherst.
- ▷ "Exploring morphosyntactic variation in low-resource English varieties". COMSC 341NL: Natural Language Processing, Mount Holyoke College.
- 2022 ▷ _____. CS 333: Natural Language Processing, Wellesley College.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Spring 2022 ▷ **Graduate Teaching Assistant**, University of Massachusetts Amherst.
CS220: Programming Methodology
- Fall 2020 ▷ **Machine Learning Club Team Leader**, University of Massachusetts Amherst.
Weekly meetings introducing NLP and Data Science concepts to undergraduates
- Fall 2019 ▷ **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, University of Massachusetts Amherst.
CS220: Programming Methodology

MENTORING

- Spring 2026 ▷ Swetha Saseendran, Sriram Kannan, Vishnu Vardhan Reddy Kandi, Heonir Feliz, "Agentic AI for Role-Based Legal Event Extraction, Timeline Construction, and Knowledge Graph Modeling in U.S. Court Cases", MS Industry Mentorship Course (*Work to be submitted to NLLP Workshop at EMNLP 2026*)
- Summer 2023 ▷ Zhangqi Duan, "Topic and User Modeling #StopAsianHate", Data Science for the Common Good MS internship (*Work accepted to WebSci 2025*)
- Spring 2023 ▷ Rahul Vippala, Veda Sree Bojanapally, Akshat Chhabra, "Data Augmentation Techniques for Machine Translation of Low Resource Coding Languages", MS Industry Mentorship Course

SERVICE & OUTREACH

- Reviewer ▷ CSCW (2024-2025)
EMNLP (2023)
FAccT (2024-2026)
ICWSM (2024-2026)
LREC-COLING (2024)
Field Matters Workshop (2023-2025)
NLP+CSS Workshop (2024, 2026)
IC2S2 (2024-2025)
- Tutorials ▷ Co-organizer, "Neural NLP methods for linguistic feature detection in sociolinguistic corpora", Bridging methods to study sociolectal variation workshop at the LSA Institute (2023)
- Panels ▷ Discussant, Computational Social Science Institute research seminar, UMass Amherst (2025)

SERVICE & OUTREACH (continued)

- Other ▷ Main coordinator, UMass NLP seminar (2025)
PhD Peer Mentor, UMass Amherst CICS (2024)
PhD mentor, COMPSCI 696DS: Industry Mentorship Course, UMass Amherst (2023, 2026)
PhD program application reader, UMass Amherst CICS (2023, 2024)
Graduate student panelist, Undergraduate Research Night, UMass Amherst CICS (2023)
PhD panelist, PhD Applicant Support Program webinar, UMass Amherst CICS (2023)
NSF GRFP mentor, UMass Amherst Graduate School (2023)
Volunteer, Building circuits with Arduino workshop, Massenberg STEM Institute (2023)
PhD mentor, PhD Applicant Support Program, UMass Amherst CICS (2020, 2023)

SKILLS

- Languages ▷ Python, Java, JavaScript, MATLAB, C, Perl
- Libraries ▷ NumPy, PyTorch, scikit-learn, SciPy, TensorFlow, NLTK
- Relevant coursework ▷ Machine Learning, Neural Networks, Natural Language Processing, Data Visualization and Exploration, Algorithms, Probability, Computer Systems Principles, Computational Linguistics, Cognitive Modeling, Syntax, Phonetics and Phonology, Theories of Learning, Fixing Social Media